

APEDA Financial Assistance for Agri-Food Exports

DRAFT FOR REVIEW | SCHEME | D022

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APEDA's Financial Assistance Scheme addresses specific gaps in agricultural and processed-food exports. Its 2021–26 framework groups assistance into export infrastructure, quality development and market development. The appropriate component follows the export problem the project will solve.

APEDA's published scheme page identifies this Finance Commission cycle as 2021–22 to 2025–26. The 2024 focus-product invitation is also a dated notice. Confirm the operative programme and current invitation before relying on these terms for a new application.

Choose the component that matches the expenditure

Export infrastructure can include specified pack-house facilities, grading and packing, pre-cooling and cold-chain facilities, treatment needed for destination-market requirements and identified processing gaps. Quality support addresses defined systems, testing and laboratory needs. Market development has its own eligible activities and participation conditions.

An applicant must also fit the relevant route, such as a registered exporter or another permitted organisation working with APEDA-scheduled products. Exporting food in general does not make every facility or marketing expense eligible.

Approval timing affects admissibility

The 2021–26 guidelines distinguish expenditure incurred before online application from expenditure incurred afterwards. Spending after an application but before in-principle approval does not automatically qualify. Component-specific exceptions also exist, so a single purchasing rule should not be assumed to govern every claim.

Check the required approval and eligible-cost basis before placing orders. For equipment, the general conditions require competitive quotations and use the lowest qualifying quoted rate for assistance calculation. For civil work, the scope is technical civil work within the notified limits.

Prepare an export-linked proposal

The application should connect the product, destination market, present constraint and proposed solution. Provide export and registration records, equipment specifications, quotations, technical civil estimates where applicable, ownership details and evidence of how the facility will be used.

After approval, retain the actual expenditure and payment records, approved scope, implementation evidence and required export-performance reporting. Assistance is released against completion and claim conditions; an application receipt is not a commitment to reimburse the full budget.

Assess the amount component by component

Rates, ceilings and category provisions vary. Calculate each eligible activity separately, including exclusions and any other support. This is especially important where a proposal combines a pack house, laboratory and certification work, which may belong to different provisions.

Read the [APEDA 2021–26 guidelines](#) and [official financial-assistance notices](#). For Haryana support connected specifically to outward shipment costs, see [Freight Assistance](#).

Discuss the next step

For help assessing the project and preparing the applicable subsidy work, see [Subsidy & Incentive Advisory](#).

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[Discuss your project](#). An expert consultant from Rapid will call you.

Source links

Links retained from this manuscript. Consult the referenced authority for current requirements; the PDF drafting date does not establish that a source remains current.

1. APEDA 2021–26 guidelines

https://apeda.gov.in/sites/default/files/2025-02/FAS_Guidelines_05102021.pdf

2. official financial-assistance notices

<https://apeda.gov.in/FinancialAssistanceSchemes>